



STATUS REPORT

Sao Tome and Principe: status report

Edition of 2026-08-25 · 49 systems and instruments tracked

Compiled 2026-08-25 by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository, from [outputs/reports/STP/Ledger.csv](#) (49 systems and instruments, 13 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

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Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

São Tomé and Príncipe's automatic electoral roll delivered its first real-world test in 2026 and the result was mixed: built under the EU-funded PReSE project and first used for the 19 July presidential election, [the roll's provisional update for the 27 September elections had to add 1,860 eligible voters](#) the automatic civil-registry derivation had missed through a process failure — deriving a roll automatically from the civil registry reproduced that register's own omissions rather than correcting them. Foundational digital identity remains mid-build: a MOSIP-based pilot with system integrator Ooru has run since 2024 with a roadmap targeting January to May 2026, while a parallel "BI para Todos" campaign issued free identity cards to remote localities using a Starlink-linked mobile brigade.

Cabo Verde and Macau both moved on data-protection cooperation with STP's regulator, ANPDP: São Tomé is a founding member of the Rede Lusófona de Proteção de Dados, and [Macau's DSPDP signed a cooperation MoU on cross-border data flows and AI supervision on 1 June 2026](#). Financing for the country's core digital-transformation programme comes almost entirely from two sources — the [World Bank's US\\$21.8m "Digital São Tomé and Príncipe" project, 36% disbursed by September 2025](#), and a 2017 AfDB payments-infrastructure grant — with no domestic budget line for digital transformation held anywhere in the base.

Thirteen of forty-eight rows are *Not held*: no compute capacity, satellite-data programme, technical-standards body, open-data portal, ICT-sector policy, or Indian or Gulf-state engagement is on record.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
AU Data Policy Framework (AUDPF) — national adoption process	IN DEVELOPMENT, WORKSHOP HELD ↗	Data Governance Capacity Building Workshop held (9-10 Jul 2026), D4D Hub with GIZ, AUDA-NEPAD, KICTANET

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National Strategy for Digital Governance (2020)	ENACTED ↗	Whole-of-government digital-transformation strategy, nine thematic axes, adopted
Programme for African Developing Island Economies (AUDA-NEPAD)	ENACTED, COMMUNIQUE ADOPTED ↗	Launched at Ministerial Segment, Abidjan; STP one of seven covered island states
Public Administration Reform Strategy (2025)	ENACTED, APPROVED ↗	Justice Minister Vera Cravid presents newly approved strategy naming e-governance its essential pillar

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
AGER regulatory framework revision (Regulatory Entities Law + Electronic Communications Law)	UNDER REVIEW, SUBMITTED TO NATIONAL ASSEMBLY ↗	Approved by Council of Ministers, submitted to National Assembly; AGER Statute already approved
Aggregated Identification Document Law (identity law)	UNDER REVIEW, DRAFTING/CONSULTATION STAGE FLAGGED URGENT ↗	World Bank mission flags review, public consultation, finalisation and approval as urgent; absence could constrain data collection
National Framework for Interoperability (Law 1/2024)	ENACTED ↗	Law enacted for public-sector data sharing
Personal Data Guarantee and Protection Law (Law 03/2016)	ENACTED ↗	Law enacted, EU Directive 95/46/EC-modelled, enforced by ANPDP

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
ANPDP membership — Rede Lusofona de Protecao de Dados (RLPD)	IMPLEMENTED, FOUNDING MEMBER ↗	CNPD (Portugal)-hosted cooperation visit; network described as 'recent-criada' (recently created)
ANPDP supervision of PReSE registry-CEN data linkage	IMPLEMENTED, OVERSIGHT ASSIGNED ↗	ANPDP assigned to supervise the civil-registry/electoral-database interconnection
Macau DSPDP-ANPDP cooperation MoU	ENACTED, SIGNED ↗	MoU signed 1 Jun 2026, covering cross-border data flows, AI supervision, awareness, training, joint studies
Malabo Convention — STP signatory status	ENACTED, SIGNATORY (RATIFICATION STATUS NOT STATED) ↗	STP signatory status noted in IBA country chapter

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Lusophone Africa Data Governance Workshop	IMPLEMENTED, SECOND EDITION HELD ↗	Second workshop held in Luanda, 15-17 Jun 2026
PALOP Digital Governance Dialogues	IMPLEMENTED, ONGOING SERIES ↗	Second webinar held (digital ID as foundational DPI)

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National technical standards or interoperability framework beyond Law 1/2024	NOT HELD	—

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
FGI STP (Forum de Governanca da Internet)	IMPLEMENTED, FIRST EDITION ONLY ↗	1st edition held, Casa Cacau, 28-30 Jul 2026, opened by the PM

Two enacted laws underpin the digital-governance framework — the Personal Data Guarantee and Protection Law (03/2016), modelled on EU Directive 95/46/EC and enforced by ANPDP, and a National Framework for Interoperability (1/2024) underpinning DEX, the citizen portal and the trade single window — though the only source held describing either is a 2024 secondary legal-survey chapter rather than the primary texts. AGER's own regulatory framework revision and a separate Aggregated Identification Document Law were both submitted for review by September 2025, with no later source confirming passage of either. [ANPDP became a founding member of the Rede Lusófona de Proteção de Dados](#) alongside Portugal, Angola, Brazil and Cabo Verde, and [Macau's DSPDP signed a cooperation MoU on cross-border data flows and AI supervision on 1 June 2026](#); ANPDP also holds oversight of the PReSE registry-CEN interconnection, assessment pending an inspection. STP is a Malabo Convention signatory, though ratification status is not established in sources held.

[AGER convened the country's first Internet Governance Forum in July 2026](#), opened by the Prime Minister, covering digital trust, infrastructure, regulation, privacy and AI, with no outcome document published. A National Strategy for Digital Governance (2020, nine axes) and a 2025 Public Administration Reform Strategy naming e-governance its essential pillar are both in force; [a Data Governance Capacity Building Workshop on national adoption of the AU Data Policy Framework ran in July 2026](#), and [AUDA-NEPAD's Programme for African Developing Island Economies, covering STP among seven states, launched the same month](#). No open-government-data portal and no distinct national technical-standards body beyond the interoperability law is on record.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Domestic-state digital-transformation budget line	NOT HELD	—

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Financing memorandum distinct from the AfDB/ World Bank/UNICEF instruments already recorded	NOT HELD	—

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
AfDB Payment System Infrastructure and Financial Inclusion Project (PISPIF)	IN DEVELOPMENT, ACTIVE (PER IATI RECORD) ↗	AfDB commits US\$3,335,999 (XDR 2,400,000) grant
UNICEF PNAD equipment procurement (grant SC220341)	PLANNED, TENDER OPEN ↗	RFQ_03/2026 open, closes 12 Aug 2026
World Bank 'Digital Sao Tome and Principe' project (P177158)	IN DEVELOPMENT, 36% DISBURSED ↗	US\$7.64m disbursed (36%) as of 11 Sep 2025, rated Moderately Satisfactory

Two financing instruments underwrite almost the whole of STP's digital-transformation programme. The [World Bank's US\\$21.8m "Digital São Tomé and Príncipe" project](#) was board-approved in June 2022 and had disbursed US\$7.64m — 36% — by September 2025, rated Moderately Satisfactory, financing the digital-ID, citizen-portal, interoperability, CSIRT and data-centre work recorded above. [The AfDB's Payment System Infrastructure and Financial Inclusion Project](#), committed in 2017 at US\$3,335,999, shows a disbursed figure of US\$4,268,636 in its IATI record — exceeding the committed amount with no explanation found in the source held, a discrepancy to treat [with caution rather than resolve here](#). UNICEF's PNAD equipment tender, open since July 2026 against grant SC220341, is the only other financing instrument on record. No domestic STP government budget line for digital transformation is held anywhere in the base — the hub's own financing aggregate marks the domestic side "pending that dataset."

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
CST national network (antennas/schools expansion)	IMPLEMENTED, ONGOING EXPANSION ↗	35th antenna inaugurated, Água Ize, Cantagalo
Starlink satellite internet service	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Service activated in STP
Submarine cable to Príncipe (STP Digital project component)	IN DEVELOPMENT, MONITORED ↗	World Bank mission lists cable progress as an active project objective

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
GoSTP data-centre modernisation (incl. digital-ID data centre/DR tender)	PLANNED, TENDER ISSUED, DECISION NOT CONFIRMED ↗	AFAP tenders servers + disaster recovery for the digital-ID data centre

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National policy linking digital infrastructure to energy supply	NOT HELD	—

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Compute or high-performance computing capacity	NOT HELD	—

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
CSIRT (Computer Security Incident Response Team)	IN DEVELOPMENT, MATERIALISATION LAUNCH FLAGGED ↗	World Bank mission lists 'launch materialisation of the CSIRT' as a mission objective

[CST's network expansion reached its 35th antenna at Água Izé, Cantagalo, in March 2026](#), ending what the operator describes as prolonged local network instability, under an expansion plan first announced in January 2025 to prioritise larger and then smaller schools. [Starlink activated commercial service in December 2025](#), after the US

chargé d'affaires publicly backed its entry in February 2025 in the same period the US closed its 32-year-old Voice of America relay station in the country; [a standard kit costs roughly US\\$257, with a residential monthly plan around US\\$79.50](#). A submarine cable to Príncipe is tracked as an active World Bank project objective with no completion status or timeline given.

A GoSTP data-centre modernisation programme, covering the digital-ID system's servers and disaster recovery, moved from three costed options — a low-cost requalification, a roughly €4.6m new TIER III build, or a hybrid still under study — to an AFAP tender for servers and disaster-recovery infrastructure by May 2026, implementing the higher-tier recommendation; the current site is flagged as high-risk given its sea-level location. A CSIRT's "materialisation launch" is named as a single line item in a September 2025 World Bank mission report, with no operational date or later confirmation found. No compute capacity beyond this tender, no satellite-data programme, and no energy-linked digital-infrastructure policy is on record.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
'BI para Todos' free national-ID campaign	IMPLEMENTED, PHASED ROLLOUT ↗	Diaspora arm — BIs collectable at STP embassy in Portugal
Foundational digital ID (STP Digital/MOSIP, System Integrator Ooru)	IN DEVELOPMENT, ROADMAP NOT CONFIRMED DELIVERED ↗	System Integrator Ooru engaged with INIC/DGRN; VCI/DEX/Portal/e-Signature prototypes live; roadmap Jan-May 2026
Passport issuance system SEP 2.0	IMPLEMENTED ↗	STP launches SEP 2.0 under a 4-year contract with Portugal's Imprensa Nacional-Casa da Moeda

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
BCSTP FinTech Sandbox	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Central Bank launches first FinTech Sandbox under the National Financial Inclusion Strategy

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Automatic electoral roll (PReSE, civil-registry to CEN interoperability)	IMPLEMENTED, QUALIFYING: FIRST USE MISSED ~1,860 ELIGIBLE VOTERS ↗	Provisional roll for 27 Sep 2026 elections carries 146,510 voters, added after a process-failure fix
Cadastro Social Unico (CSU) — single social registry	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Agency states CSU coverage figure and clarifies it is not a poverty count
Guiche Unico de Empresas (GUE) — business registry modernisation	UNDER REVIEW, DIAGNOSTIC COMPLETE ↗	World Bank mission presents legal/ICT diagnostic findings toward a modern, data-oriented business registry

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
EMAE management information system (MIS) tender	PLANNED, TENDER DEADLINE EXTENDED ↗	AFAP extends deadline of tender ref. 45-G for supply/installation/training/commissioning of a new MIS for EMAE

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Computing equipment for the tax directorate	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Equipment handed over 2026-08-18
Portal do Cidadao / Citizen Portal (INIC, beta)	PILOTING, BETA ↗	Beta launched at INIC's 18th anniversary, funded by World Bank + Co-Develop, CDPI technical advisory
Trade Single Window + ASYFIVE (UNDP-supported)	PLANNED, ANNOUNCED ↗	UNDP-backed integrated Port/External-Trade Single Window + ASYFIVE deployment announced

Foundational digital identity has been piloting since 2024 on MOSIP with system integrator Ooru, with [VCI, DEX, portal and e-signature prototypes already live by September 2025](#) and a roadmap running January to May 2026 — no source held confirms the foundational ID card itself has launched. Running alongside it, [the "BI para Todos" campaign issued free identity cards to remote localities](#) including Ilhéu das Rolas and Porto Alegre, reached by a Starlink-linked mobile brigade, with diaspora collection available at the STP embassy in Portugal. [SEP 2.0, a new passport-issuance system, launched in April 2026](#) under a four-year contract with Portugal's Imprensa Nacional–Casa da Moeda.

The EU-funded PReSE electoral-roll project delivered its first real test in 2026: [built from automatic civil-registry interconnection and first used for the 19 July presidential election](#), the provisional roll for the 27 September elections had to add back 1,860 eligible voters a process failure had omitted. [The Cadastro Social Único single social registry](#) covers around 12,500 households, roughly a quarter of the population, with the agency itself stating this is registration, not a poverty count. [INIC's Portal do Cidadão / Citizen Portal beta launched at INIC's 18th anniversary in March 2026](#), financed by the World Bank and Co-Develop, with a stated pathway toward verifiable tax and police-clearance credentials. [A UNDP-backed Trade Single Window and ASYFIVE deployment was announced in January 2026](#), integrating 22 public and private institutions and positioning STP as the first African ASYFIVE deployer, not yet reported live. No dedicated rural digital-service programme, no district-administration digitisation, and no earth-observation programme is on record.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digitisation of district-administration systems	NOT HELD	—

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Dedicated rural digital-service programme	NOT HELD	—

Technology

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
ICT sector size or industry-policy programme	NOT HELD	—

No dedicated AI, ICT-industry, Indian or Gulf-state instrument is on record for São Tomé and Príncipe. Artificial intelligence and technology surface only as themes inside instruments homed elsewhere: [AGER's July 2026 Internet Governance Forum](#) named "AI challenges and opportunities" one of its agenda tracks, [AUDA-NEPAD's island-economies programme](#) names AI and automation an "accelerator" of its digital-transformation pillar, and [Macau's DSPDP MoU](#) covers AI supervision as one of its cooperation areas. This absence is genuine rather than a reading gap — no source held names an STP AI strategy, ICT-sector policy, or Indian or Gulf-state financing or vendor engagement.

Capacity

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
CST school-connectivity plan	PLANNED, ANNOUNCED ↗	Plan to expand fibre/mobile to schools, larger schools first, then to 9th-grade level, with Education Ministry
National Digital Learning Programme (PNAD) — equipment procurement	PLANNED, TENDER OPEN ↗	UNICEF opens tender RFQ_03/2026 (closes 12 Aug 2026) for 80 tablets + 90 desktops for school ICT rooms

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Applied digital-research programme	NOT HELD	—

Inclusion

The base holds no inclusion rows for Sao Tome and Principe. A thin evidence base is a finding, not a gap in this document.

CST's January 2025 plan to extend fibre and mobile connectivity to schools, larger schools first, down to 9th-grade level, has no confirmed progress in any later source. [UNICEF opened a tender in July 2026 for 80 tablets and 90 desktop computers](#) for school ICT rooms under the National Digital Learning Programme, against grant SC220341, with delivery preferred by the second week of September 2026 and no contract value stated. No applied digital-research programme is on record.

Data

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Open government data portal	NOT HELD	—

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Earth-observation or satellite-data programme	NOT HELD	—

Geopolitics

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Gulf-state digital investment in STP	NOT HELD	—

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Indian digital-sector engagement with STP	NOT HELD	—

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National policy linking digital infrastructure to energy supply	A national policy or programme document connecting power reliability or generation to digital-infrastructure planning.	not yet probed
Compute or high-performance computing capacity	A data-centre, cloud or high-performance computing specification distinct from the GoSTP data-centre tender.	not yet probed
Earth-observation or satellite-data programme	A national earth-observation or geospatial-data programme document.	not yet probed
Dedicated rural digital-service programme	A programme document distinct from the CST school-connectivity plan.	not yet probed
Digitisation of district-administration systems	A district-administration system specification or digitisation programme document.	not yet probed
National technical standards or interoperability framework beyond Law 1/2024	A distinct standards body or technical-specification document.	not yet probed
Open government data portal	A public-sector open-data portal or policy document.	not yet probed
ICT sector size or industry-policy programme	An ICT-sector policy, statistics publication or industry-support programme document.	not yet probed
Indian digital-sector engagement with STP	Any Indian government or vendor financing, contract or memorandum covering STP.	not yet probed
Gulf-state digital investment in STP	Any Gulf-state investment, financing or memorandum covering STP.	not yet probed
Applied digital-research programme	A university, agency or donor-funded applied digital-research programme document.	not yet probed
Financing memorandum distinct from the AfDB/World Bank/ UNICEF instruments already recorded	A separate financing MoU not already captured under finance.new.	not yet probed
Domestic-state digital-transformation budget line	An STP government budget document or appropriation line for digital transformation.	not yet probed

Thirteen of forty-eight rows carry no instrument, split between infrastructure the country's development-financing programme has not yet reached (compute capacity, satellite data, energy policy) and foreign engagement the record simply does not show (India, the Gulf states, any financing MoU beyond the three donor instruments already recorded). None names a specific document an automated fetch could plausibly retrieve — each is a genuine absence, consistent with a country of [fewer than 350,000 people](#) whose entire digital-transformation programme runs through 39 sources and three financing instruments.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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